



HARVESTING

Harvest endives as required—either cut the whole head off and wait for new leaves to resprout, or harvest individual leaves as a cut-and-come-again crop.

BLANCHING

Preventing light from reaching the leaves will blanch them and reduce their bitter flavor. Cover frisée types with a plate or gather up and tie together the leaves of Batavian types shortly before crops are ready to harvest. Block the light for about 10 days. After this time, the leaves will have whitened and be ready to eat.

PESTS AND DISEASES

Be vigilant against slugs, since they will probably be the biggest threat to your crop. Use slug pellets, or if you prefer, protect plants with cloches or set up beer traps. Also consider laying grit, diatomaceous earth (DE), or copper tape as a barrier. Aphids and caterpillars may also target your crops: pick off any caterpillars that you find, and spray infested plants with an appropriate insecticide. Lettuce root aphid, which feed on plant roots, and tip burn, which shrivels the rims of leaves, might pose a problem.